Employee Relations Toolkit for Managers (U.S.)

Use this toolkit for the first conversation. Anything in the escalate column goes to Employee Relations before you act.

Decide where it belongs

Situation	Handle yourself	Escalate first
Repeated lateness	Yes, coaching conversation	If a disability or leave may be involved
Missed deliverable	Yes, document in a note	If it follows a formal plan
Peer conflict	Yes, facilitate once	If either party alleges harassment
Allegation of discrimination	No	Always, same day
Request for an accommodation	No	Always, route to Absence Management
Possible policy violation involving money	No	Always, Compliance

A coaching conversation that works

1. Open with the observation, not the conclusion. 'The last three status reports came in after the deadline' rather than 'you are unreliable'.
2. Ask what is getting in the way and listen to the whole answer before responding.
3. Agree on one specific change and a date to review it.
4. Write a short note the same day: date, what was discussed, what was agreed.
5. Follow up on the date you agreed, even if things improved.

Sample language

When a colleague mentions a health issue during a performance conversation: 'Thank you for telling me. I am not going to ask for details. I am going to connect you with Absence Management, who can talk through what support is available. Let us pause the performance discussion until you have had that conversation.'

When a colleague asks you to keep an allegation confidential: 'I want to support you, and I also have to be honest that I cannot promise confidentiality for something like this. I am required to involve Employee Relations. I will tell you what I pass on.'

What not to do

- Do not investigate an allegation of harassment or discrimination yourself.
- Do not ask about a diagnosis, a treatment plan, or a clinician's name.
- Do not keep a private file of performance notes outside Workday.
- Do not discuss one colleague's performance or pay with another colleague.

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- Do not promise an outcome you do not control, including a rating or a transfer.

Contacts

Need	Contact	Response target
Employee Relations consult	ER Partner for your business area	1 business day
Accommodation or leave	Absence Management via People Central	2 business days
Ethics or compliance	Ethics Helpline	Immediate intake

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